

RAMCO VIDYA MANDIR SR. SEC. SCHOOL, THAMARAikulAM
CLASS 12 ENGLISH REVISION – SR6 MEMORIES OF CHILDHOOD

Marks :

Name :

Duration :

Exam No. :

Section A: Extract-Based Comprehension (3 × 5 = 15 marks)

Extract 1: (*Zitkala-Sa*)

“I cried aloud, shaking my head all the while until I felt the cold blades of the scissors against my neck, and heard them gnaw off one of my thick braids. Then I lost my spirit.”

1. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

Q1: What does the cutting of hair symbolize for Zitkala-Sa?

- (a) A fashion change
- (b) A rite of passage
- (c) Loss of cultural identity and dignity
- (d) A punishment for disobedience **Answer:** (c) Loss of cultural identity and dignity

Q2: What is Zitkala-Sa’s emotional response to the haircut?

- (a) Joy
- (b) Anger
- (c) Humiliation and defeat
- (d) Indifference **Answer:** (c) Humiliation and defeat

2. Assertion–Reasoning Questions

Q3: Assertion: Zitkala-Sa willingly allowed her hair to be cut. Reason: She wanted to adapt to the new culture.

- (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.
- (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true. **Answer:** (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true

Q4: Assertion: The haircut was a traumatic experience for Zitkala-Sa. Reason: It represented forced assimilation and loss of freedom. **Answer:** (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion

3. Find the Meaning

Q5: What does “gnaw off” imply in this context? **Answer:** It suggests a harsh, painful, and forceful cutting, evoking violence and emotional distress.

4. Tone / Mood

Q6: What is the tone of this extract?

- (a) Celebratory
- (b) Defiant
- (c) Tragic
- (d) Humorous **Answer:** (c) Tragic

5. Analogy-Based Question

Q7: The act of cutting Zitkala-Sa’s hair is most similar to:

- (a) A soldier shaving before battle
- (b) A child getting a haircut at home
- (c) A prisoner losing personal identity
- (d) A monk renouncing worldly life **Answer:** (c) A prisoner losing personal identity

□ **Extract 2: (Zitkala-Sa)**

“Since the day I was taken from my mother I had suffered extreme indignities. People had stared at me. I had been tossed about in the air like a wooden puppet.”

1. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

Q1: What does Zitkala-Sa compare herself to?

- (a) A brave warrior
- (b) A wooden puppet
- (c) A wild animal
- (d) A doll **Answer:** (b) A wooden puppet

Q2: What does the phrase “extreme indignities” refer to?

- (a) Physical punishment
- (b) Cultural disrespect and emotional abuse
- (c) Academic failure
- (d) Hunger and poverty **Answer:** (b) Cultural disrespect and emotional abuse

2. Assertion–Reasoning Questions

Q3: Assertion: Zitkala-Sa felt empowered in her new environment. Reason: She was treated with respect and dignity. **Answer:** (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true

Q4: Assertion: Zitkala-Sa’s experiences reflect forced assimilation. Reason: She was denied her cultural practices and identity. **Answer:** (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion

3. Find the Meaning

Q5: What does “tossed about like a wooden puppet” imply? **Answer:** It implies a lack of control, dehumanization, and being manipulated without consent.

4. Tone / Mood

Q6: What is the mood conveyed in this extract?

- (a) Joyful
- (b) Humiliated
- (c) Hopeful
- (d) Curious **Answer:** (b) Humiliated

5. Analogy-Based Question

Q7: Zitkala-Sa’s treatment is most similar to:

- (a) A student being praised in class
- (b) A performer on stage
- (c) A puppet controlled by strings
- (d) A teacher giving instructions **Answer:** (c) A puppet controlled by strings

□ **Extract 3: (Bama)**

“The elder went straight up to the landlord, bowed low and extended the packet towards him, cupping the hand that held the string with his other hand.”

1. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

Q1: What does the elder's gesture reflect?

- (a) Respect and equality
- (b) Humour and playfulness
- (c) Caste-based submission and fear
- (d) Religious devotion **Answer:** (c) Caste-based submission and fear

Q2: Why does the elder avoid touching the packet directly?

- (a) It was hot
- (b) It was dirty
- (c) He feared polluting the landlord
- (d) He was joking **Answer:** (c) He feared polluting the landlord

2. Assertion–Reasoning Questions

Q3: Assertion: The elder's behaviour was humorous. Reason: He was trying to entertain the landlord. **Answer:** (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true

Q4: Assertion: Bama initially found the scene funny. Reason: She was unaware of the caste discrimination behind it. **Answer:** (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion

3. Find the Meaning

Q5: What does “cupping the hand” imply in this context? **Answer:** It implies exaggerated humility and submission, reflecting caste-based servitude.

4. Tone / Mood

Q6: What is the tone of this extract from Bama's perspective after realization?

- (a) Amused
- (b) Angry and reflective
- (c) Indifferent
- (d) Proud **Answer:** (b) Angry and reflective

5. Analogy-Based Question

Q7: The elder's gesture is most similar to:

- (a) A waiter serving food
- (b) A devotee offering prayer
- (c) A servant obeying a master
- (d) A child giving a gift **Answer:** (c) A servant obeying a master

□ Extract 4: (Bama)

“But we too are human beings. Our people should never run these petty errands for these fellows. We should work in their fields, take home our wages, and leave it at that.”

1. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

Q1: What does Bama assert in this extract?

- (a) That her people should serve landlords
- (b) That her people deserve dignity and equality
- (c) That her people should avoid education
- (d) That her people are superior **Answer:** (b) That her people deserve dignity and equality

Q2: What kind of work does Bama approve of?

- (a) Errands and servitude

- (b) Field work with fair wages
- (c) Domestic chores
- (d) Religious rituals **Answer:** (b) Field work with fair wages

2. Assertion–Reasoning Questions

Q3: Assertion: Bama supports caste-based hierarchy. Reason: She believes her people should serve landlords. **Answer:** (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true

Q4: Assertion: Bama advocates for dignity and self-respect. Reason: She believes in earning wages through honest labour. **Answer:** (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion

3. Find the Meaning

Q5: What does “petty errands” mean in this context? **Answer:** It refers to humiliating tasks done out of caste-based obligation, not choice or respect.

4. Tone / Mood

Q6: What is the mood of Bama’s voice in this extract?

- (a) Submissive
- (b) Assertive and rebellious
- (c) Confused
- (d) Humorous **Answer:** (b) Assertive and rebellious

Section B: Short Answer Questions (12 × 2 = 24 marks)

Story-Based Questions (2 × 2 Marks = 4 Marks)

Q1. What incident from Zitkala-Sa’s school experience left a lasting impact on her?

Answer: Zitkala-Sa was forcibly made to cut her long hair, which symbolized dignity and cultural pride in her tribe. The act was humiliating and traumatic, marking her first experience of cultural oppression and loss of identity. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for describing the incident
- 1 mark for explaining its emotional impact

Q2. What did Bama find amusing about the elder’s behavior with the snack packet?

Answer: Bama initially found it funny that the elder carried the snack packet by its string, avoiding direct contact. She laughed at his exaggerated caution, unaware that it stemmed from caste-based discrimination. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for describing the behavior
- 1 mark for explaining Bama’s reaction

Moral-Based Questions (2 × 2 Marks = 4 Marks)

Q3. What moral lesson does Bama learn from her brother’s advice? Answer: Bama learns that education and excellence can challenge caste-based discrimination. Her brother encourages her to study hard and earn respect through merit, rather than accept humiliation.

Marking Scheme:

- 1 mark for stating the lesson
- 1 mark for linking it to her brother’s advice

Q4. What does Zitkala-Sa’s resistance to haircutting teach us about dignity? Answer: Zitkala-Sa’s refusal to submit shows her strong sense of dignity and cultural pride. Her

struggle teaches that resisting injustice, even in small ways, is a powerful assertion of self-worth. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for describing her resistance
- 1 mark for interpreting the moral value

Character-Based Questions (2 × 2 Marks = 4 Marks)

Q5. How is Zitkala-Sa portrayed as a child in the story? Answer: Zitkala-Sa is portrayed as sensitive, proud, and courageous. Despite being young, she understands the cultural significance of her hair and resists the forced haircut, showing emotional strength and awareness. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying traits
- 1 mark for supporting with example

Q6. What does Bama's character reveal about her awareness and growth? Answer: Bama evolves from innocent amusement to deep awareness of caste injustice. Her anger and resolve to study hard reflect her growing maturity and determination to fight discrimination through education. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for describing her growth
- 1 mark for linking it to her response

Theme-Based Questions (2 × 2 Marks = 4 Marks)

Q7. What common theme connects the experiences of Zitkala-Sa and Bama? Answer: Both narratives highlight the theme of social discrimination—Zitkala-Sa faces racial and cultural oppression, while Bama experiences caste-based humiliation. Their stories reflect the pain of marginalization and the desire for dignity. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying the theme
- 1 mark for linking it to both characters

Q8. How does the theme of resistance emerge in both stories? Answer: Zitkala-Sa resists the haircut, and Bama resolves to study hard to overcome caste barriers. Both show early signs of rebellion against injustice, emphasizing the theme of resistance and self-assertion. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying resistance
- 1 mark for supporting with examples

Competency-Based Questions (2 × 2 Marks = 4 Marks)

Q9. How does Bama's brother help her understand caste discrimination? Answer: Bama's brother explains that the elder's behavior was due to caste rules that label Dalits as impure. He urges her to fight this injustice through education and excellence, guiding her toward empowerment. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for describing the explanation
- 1 mark for linking it to Bama's realization

Q10. How does Zitkala-Sa's experience reflect forced assimilation? Answer: Zitkala-Sa is forced to abandon her cultural identity—her hair is cut, her moccasins replaced, and she must follow unfamiliar customs. These actions reflect the dominant culture's attempt to erase her Native heritage. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying assimilation
- 1 mark for supporting with examples

Situation-Based Questions (2 × 2 Marks = 4 Marks)

Q11. What was Bama's emotional reaction after learning the truth about the elder's behavior? Answer: Bama felt deeply hurt and angry. Her amusement turned into sadness and fury as she realized the elder's actions were rooted in caste-based humiliation. This moment sparked her desire to resist injustice. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for describing her reaction
- 1 mark for explaining its significance

Q12. How did Zitkala-Sa respond when she was discovered hiding under the bed? Answer: Zitkala-Sa resisted fiercely—kicking and scratching—but was forcibly dragged out and tied to a chair. Her response shows her desperation to protect her identity and her refusal to submit quietly. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for describing her response
- 1 mark for interpreting its emotional depth

Section C: Long Answer Questions (4 × 5 = 20 marks)

1. Character-Based Question

Q: Compare the personalities of Zitkala-Sa and Bama based on their childhood experiences.

Answer: Zitkala-Sa and Bama, though from different cultures, share a strong sense of identity and resilience. Both are young girls who experience discrimination—Zitkala-Sa due to her Native American heritage, and Bama due to her Dalit background.

Zitkala-Sa is sensitive and proud of her traditions. Her resistance to having her hair cut reflects her courage and refusal to submit to forced assimilation. Bama, on the other hand, is observant and spirited. Her initial amusement turns into anger when she understands the caste-based humiliation behind the elder's behavior. She channels her frustration into a resolve to study hard and earn respect.

Both characters emerge as symbols of early rebellion. Their strength lies in their ability to recognize injustice and respond with dignity and determination, making them powerful voices against social oppression.

Marking Scheme (5 marks):

- 1 mark: Introduction of characters
- 2 marks: Comparison with textual support
- 1 mark: Interpretation of traits
- 1 mark: Coherent conclusion

2. Theme-Based Question

Q: Discuss the theme of discrimination in *Memories of Childhood*.

Answer: *Memories of Childhood* presents two autobiographical episodes that highlight the theme of discrimination. Zitkala-Sa faces racial and cultural oppression, while Bama experiences caste-based humiliation in her village.

Zitkala-Sa's forced haircut and loss of cultural symbols reflect the dominant society's attempt to erase Native identity. Bama's realization that her people are considered impure and untouchable deeply affects her. Both girls feel the sting of being treated as inferior, not for who they are, but for what they represent in society.

The theme of discrimination is central to both narratives. It shows how marginalization begins early in life and how children, despite their age, can perceive and respond to injustice. The stories urge readers to reflect on social inequalities and the need for dignity and respect for all.

Marking Scheme (5 marks):

- 1 mark: Introduction of theme
- 2 marks: Examples from both texts
- 1 mark: Interpretation and insight
- 1 mark: Coherent conclusion

3. Competency-Based Question

Q: How do Zitkala-Sa and Bama respond to the injustice they face?

Answer: Both Zitkala-Sa and Bama respond to injustice with awareness and resistance. Their reactions reflect emotional intelligence and a desire to reclaim dignity.

Zitkala-Sa physically resists the haircut, hiding under a bed and struggling against the authorities. Her defiance shows her unwillingness to surrender her cultural identity. Bama, though initially unaware, becomes angry after her brother explains the caste-based discrimination. She chooses education as her weapon, determined to excel and earn respect. Their responses are shaped by their circumstances, but both reflect a refusal to accept humiliation. Zitkala-Sa's rebellion is immediate and physical; Bama's is thoughtful and strategic. Together, they show that even children can recognize injustice and take steps to challenge it.

Marking Scheme (5 marks):

- 1 mark: Introduction of context
- 2 marks: Description of responses
- 1 mark: Interpretation of emotional strength
- 1 mark: Coherent conclusion

4. Dialogue-Based Question

Q: How does Bama's conversation with her brother change her perspective?

Answer: Bama's conversation with her elder brother is a turning point in her understanding of caste discrimination. Initially amused by the elder's way of carrying a snack packet, she laughs at the scene.

Her brother explains that the elder's behavior stems from caste rules that label Dalits as impure. This revelation shocks Bama and replaces her laughter with anger and sadness. She realizes the depth of humiliation her community faces and feels provoked to resist.

The dialogue is simple but powerful. It transforms Bama's innocent observation into a mature understanding of social injustice. Her brother's advice to study hard becomes her motivation to fight discrimination through education and excellence.

Marking Scheme (5 marks):

- 1 mark: Introduction of the dialogue
- 2 marks: Description of change in perspective
- 1 mark: Emotional and social insight
- 1 mark: Coherent conclusion

5. Speech-Based Question

Q: Imagine you are Bama. Write a speech on “Education as a Tool for Social Change.”

Answer: Good morning everyone. I am Bama, and I want to speak about how education can change lives. As a child, I saw how my people were treated unfairly—made to serve others, denied dignity, and humiliated because of caste.

One day, my brother told me that if I studied hard, I could earn respect and challenge this injustice. His words changed me. I worked with all my breath and being, and I stood first in my class. People who once ignored me began to admire me.

Education gave me a voice. It gave me confidence. It helped me rise above discrimination. So I say to every child—study, learn, grow. Education is not just for success; it is for freedom. Thank you.

Marking Scheme (5 marks):

- 1 mark: Clear opening and relevance of topic
- 2 marks: Use of textual references and examples
- 1 mark: Personal insight or reflection
- 1 mark: Effective conclusion

6. Article-Based Question

Q: Write an article on “Childhood Experiences and the Awakening to Social Injustice” using *Memories of Childhood* as reference.

Answer: Childhood is often seen as innocent and carefree, but for many, it is the beginning of awareness about social injustice. In *Memories of Childhood*, Zitkala-Sa and Bama share powerful episodes that reveal how discrimination affects even the youngest minds.

Zitkala-Sa, a Native American girl, is forced to cut her hair—a symbol of cultural pride. Her resistance shows her early understanding of racial oppression. Bama, a Tamil Dalit girl, realizes the cruelty of caste when she sees an elder humiliated while serving a landlord. Her brother’s explanation awakens her to the reality of untouchability.

These experiences sow the seeds of rebellion. They show that children are not blind to injustice—they feel it deeply. The article reminds us that social change begins with awareness, and that even small moments in childhood can shape a lifelong fight for dignity.

Marking Scheme (5 marks):

- 1 mark: Introduction of concept
- 2 marks: Examples from the text
- 1 mark: Analysis of impact
- 1 mark: Conclusion with relevance